

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Communications outage

COMMUNICATIONS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Conserve phone battery, try short texts for nonurgent check-ins and use a battery radio for official information. For immediate danger, try calling local emergency services; text-to-911 availability varies. Do not travel into danger just to find signal.

Do now.

**Check alternatives**

01

Try a safe available landline, another carrier or Wi-Fi calling if configured and functioning.

**Keep messages short**

02

Send your location, status and next check-in time to your out-of-area contact.

**Protect battery**

03

Lower brightness, enable low-power mode and limit unnecessary use.

**Use the meeting plan**

04

If networks fail completely, follow the agreed safe meeting and contact arrangements.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Write a short message with your status, location and next check-in time; try it periodically rather than draining the battery with constant retries. Use your agreed meeting plan only when the route is safe. Do not split up to hunt for signal.

Watch for.

A message sent is not necessarily delivered. Do not assume emergency texting is supported everywhere.

People & practical needs.

Give each person a written contact card and explain what to do if separated. Plan for hearing, vision, language and literacy needs

Next decision.

Keep paper contact lists, offline maps and a radio. Arrange check-in times before a crisis.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Communications outage · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/communications-outage/>